

TKT-2026-0805-301 - Sharp rise in size-related returns across footwear catalogue

Support Ticket | Support

Document ID	TKT-2026-0805-301	Seller ID	S004
Department	Support	Classification	CONFIDENTIAL
Owner	Rahul Sharma	Created Date	2026-08-05
Related Scenario ID	SC-006	Document Type	Support Ticket

Ticket Header

Field	Value
Ticket ID	TKT-2026-0805-301
Seller	S004 - StrideOne Footwear
Raised by	Karan Mehta, Marketplace Lead
Channel	Seller portal, with a data extract attached
Raised at	2026-08-05 12:15 IST
Priority	P2 - High, raised to P1 on 2026-08-07
Category	Catalogue data and returns
Assigned to	Rahul Sharma, Support
Escalated to	Vikram Singh (Engineering), Neha Gupta (Operations)
Closed at	2026-08-21 16:45 IST
Final status	Resolved - feed defect fixed, charts republished

Report

Karan did not report a broken function. He reported a pattern, and he brought evidence:

- Return rate had risen from a 9 percent baseline to 27 percent over three weeks.
- 'Size too small' had gone from 14 percent of return reasons to 71 percent.
- The rise was not limited to one brand, one partner or one product line.
- Nothing had changed on StrideOne's side in that period.

His conclusion in the ticket was blunt: "either every one of our four partners simultaneously started making smaller shoes, or your size charts are wrong."

Initial Assessment

I took the pattern seriously for three reasons. It was broad, it was reason-code specific, and it coincided with nothing on the seller's side.

My first check was whether the published size chart matched the partner source data for a sample of SKUs. I took twenty SKUs across three brands.

Sample	Partner source size	Published size	Difference
6 sneakers, Brand A	UK 8	EU 40	Approximately two sizes small
5 formal, Brand B	UK 9	EU 41	Approximately two sizes small
5 outdoor, Brand C	UK 10	EU 42	Approximately two sizes small
4 sneakers, Brand D	EU 42	EU 42	Correct

A UK 8 converts to approximately EU 42, not EU 40. Brands supplying in UK sizing were being published roughly two sizes small. Brand D, which supplies in EU sizing already, was correct.

That was consistent with a conversion being applied twice, and it was enough to escalate with a concrete hypothesis rather than a vague complaint.

Escalation and Priority Change

Escalated to Engineering on 5 August at 16:30 with the sampling table.

Raised from P2 to P1 on 7 August when Operations established the commercial scale: 2,860 returns in the affected window, reverse logistics cost rising, and a return rate approaching the 25 percent risk threshold that triggers automated account review. At that point it stopped being a data quality ticket and became an account risk ticket.

Cause

A schema update to the dropship feed importer on 14 July 2026 changed how size attributes were read. The UK-to-EU conversion was applied twice for any partner supplying UK sizing. Published size charts were approximately two sizes smaller than the physical product.

Detail is in INC-2026-0805.

Timeline

Date	Event
2026-07-14	Feed importer schema update deployed, defect introduced
2026-07-19 to 08-02	Return rate rises from 11 to 24 percent
2026-08-05	Seller raises ticket with pattern evidence
2026-08-05	Support sampling confirms double conversion hypothesis
2026-08-05	Escalated to Engineering
2026-08-07	Raised to P1 on commercial impact
2026-08-12	Conversion logic corrected in the importer
2026-08-19	Corrected size charts republished across the catalogue
2026-08-19	Structural feed validation deployed
2026-08-21	Seller confirms sampling correct, ticket closed

Impact

Measure	Value
Duration of defect in production	36 days
Returns in the affected window	2,860
Returns above baseline	approximately 1,950
Peak return rate	27 percent
Customers offered a free exchange	2,860
Exchanges accepted	1,410

Resolution

Conversion corrected on 12 August, charts republished on 19 August, and a structural validation rule deployed the same day that rejects a feed whose published size distribution differs materially from the partner source. Affected customers were offered free exchanges at the correct size. Reverse logistics cost was absorbed by the platform.

Consequence That Followed

This ticket closed on 21 August. On 8 September the automated risk rule suspended the S004 account because the trailing 30-day return rate still exceeded 25 percent, even though the weekly rate had already fallen to 13 percent. That suspension is ticket TKT-2026-0908-341 and decision DR-2026-047.

Support Observation

The seller detected this, not the platform. There was no control comparing published size distribution against source, and no alert on a return reason code shifting from 14 percent to 71 percent of volume. The first control now exists. The second does not.